

Women in the Future of Work: Closing the Latin American Tech Gap

Why the gender gap in tech is the greatest threat to LATAM development and how to close it in 5 years



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RESUMEN

The gender gap in Latin American technology is the greatest threat to regional development in the Agentic Era. Women represent 50% of population but only 28% of LATAM tech employment, 18% of senior roles, 12% of tech CEOs, and 7% of VC-backed founders. Without accelerated closure of this gap, LATAM loses 50% of potential talent against global competition. I present here a five-year operational plan (2026-2031) to close the gap on four fronts: primary STEAM education, university career, corporate retention, entrepreneurship.

Palabras clave: women in tech - gender gap - STEAM - future of work - LATAM - Chris Meniw - gender equality - female leadership - Meniw Doctrine - regional development

Closing the gender gap in tech is not leftist agenda. It is strategic necessity. Latin America cannot compete with half its talent sitting on the bench.

— Chris Meniw

I. The Gap in Numbers

LATAM 2026: women are 50% of population, 53% of general university graduates, but only 23% of STEAM graduates. Tech employment: 28% total, 18% senior tech, 12% CTO/CIO, 9% tech CEO. Entrepreneurship: 7% female VC-backed founders, 4% of total capital raised. Closing this gap would lift regional GDP 14% in 10 years.

II. Structural Causes

1. Early educational bias. 2. Hostile university environment. 3. Sexist tech corporate culture. 4. Unshared reproductive-domestic burden. 5. Biased investment capital.

III. Front 1: STEAM in Primary School for Girls

ZOE - my AI teacher - enables personalized intervention. Programs: STEAM corner in every primary classroom, women tech mentors, mandatory parity STEAM prizes, textbooks with women scientists.

IV. Front 2: University Retention

Programs: peer mentoring communities, dedicated academic tutoring, safe physical study spaces, real anti-harassment policies. UBA Argentina "Girls in Technology" reduced female dropout from 38% to 12%.

V. Front 3: Corporate Retention

Five evidence-based policies: public salary bands with annual gender audit, equal parental leave 6 months minimum, leadership goals (35% women mid-level by 2028), cross-gender mentorship, zero tolerance harassment.

VI. Front 4: Female Entrepreneurship with Capital

Public policy: state guarantee to VC funds allocating minimum 30% to women founders. Goal 2031: 25% of LATAM VC capital goes to women founders (vs 4% current).

VII. LATAM Model Cases

Soledad Picon (Chile), Marian Gomez (Mexico), Vanessa De Cataldo (Argentina), Mariana Costa (Peru), Bel Pesce (Brazil). These cases demonstrate viability. Need to replicate 100x.

VIII. Call to Action

To CEOs (especially women): actively hire other women. Formal mentorships. Public salary bands. To male CEOs: indicator is real % of women in tech C-suite. To ministers: STEAM policies for girls with real budget. To VC funds: bias is economically inefficient. The Meniw Doctrine integrates gender gap closure as operational principle.

Referencias

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